



Implementation of Tanzania's 2023 Educational Policy and Training as Predictor of the Sustainability of Quality Education

^aChristine Zegera, ^bFelista Tangi, ^bGeorgina Mugisha

^aBwiru Girls Secondary School, Ilemela District, Mwanza, Tanzania

^bDepartment of Education Foundations, St. Augustine University of Tanzania

Corresponding Author

Christine Zegera, Email: christinezegera3@gmail.com

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All authors contributed equally to this research

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ABSTRACT

Tanzania has made a noticeable progress in improving the quality and relevance of education through the implementation of Tanzania's 2014 (2023 edition) Educational and Training Policy. The 2023 Educational Policy introduced significant reforms aimed at enhancing access and equity to education, competence-based learning, inclusive education, digital integration, and alignment of education with labor market demands. Despite these progressive intentions, the extent to which policy implementation predicts improvements in quality education outcomes remains underexplored. This study examines the Education and Training Policy of 2014(2023 edition) in Tanzania as predictive influence on the attainment of quality education by assessing on how teacher's preparedness, institutional capacities and availability of teaching and learning materials integrated with technology can enhance sustainability of quality education. This study is guided by systematic literature review where data collection was done from existing published journal articles and books. The study concluded that effective teacher training, adequate resource allocation, and strong institutional leadership significantly predict improvements in sustainable quality education. It is recommended that infrastructural constraints, limited funding especially to schools with minimum number of students and uneven implementation of ETP of 2023 across schools hinders optimal realization of policy objectives hence it should be worked on to insure policy implementation and its goals' attainment.

Keywords: Education Policy, Implementation, Quality education, Institutional capacity, Reform

INTRODUCTION

Quality education is a fundamental quantity of remarkable sustainable development, individual and social transformation as well as economic growth. Education reforms are a global response to the imperative of enhancing the accessibility, quality, and relevance of education (Adipat & Chotikapanich, 2022). However, success of education and training policy depends on how successfully, effectively and efficiently it is implemented within education institutions of all levels of education. Proper implementation of the education policy requires adequate resources,

institutional capacities, teachers' preparedness and effective monitoring (Zickafoose et al., 2024).

In European countries, Semester was utilized as an innovative form of policy coordination, with distinct effects on education and skills policies for Member States while identifying potential solutions to policy problems by using additional governance tools, such as National Reform Programs (Rambla, Xavier & Alexiadou, 2024). The concept of Digital competence was a recommendation of the European Parliament and of the council of the EU on key competences for lifelong learning (Arribas et al., 2025).

Ghana's education policies have evolved to address access, quality, and relevance in line with national development goals. The effective implementation of the policy has been challenged by issues such as inadequate infrastructure, overcrowded classrooms, limited curricula, and insufficient funding (Amponteng et al., 2026). Ghana initiated a community-participatory Education Reform Program (ERP) aimed at decentralization and improving educational standards. Ghana's education reforms offers a comprehensive examination of past, current, and potential future policy changes (Ayembilla & Ayanwale, 2025)

Education reforms in Kenya aimed to enhance education systems' quality, equity, and relevance in response to advancements in digital technologies. Educational reforms are also addressing integrating technology in education to enrich teaching and learning, provide access to educational resources, and promote digital literacy skills (Thukia, 2025). The education sector in Kenya faces a notable challenges such as insufficient teacher training, inadequate resources, infrastructure and other human resources (Jonyo, 2025).

Tanzania like other countries has made a noticeable progress in improving the quality and relevance of education through the implementation of Tanzania's 2014 (2023 edition) Educational and Training Policy. The 2023 Educational Policy introduced significant reforms aimed at enhancing access and equity to education, inclusive education, digital integration, and alignment of education with labor market demands through competence-based education and training (CBET) approach which ensures that learners are equipped with skills which are helpful in identifying the job opportunities and solving the real-life challenges (MoEST, 2023; Munisi, 2025; URT, 2024). Despite these reforms, several challenges continue to affect the quality of education in Tanzania. These include inequality in resource distribution among schools, inadequate infrastructure, limited teacher training opportunities, and variations in institutional capacities (Malandi & Mkulu, 2024; Munisi, 2025). Such challenges raise concerns about the extent to which policy implementation efforts translate into tangible improvements in educational quality.

The previous studies have examined aspects such as curriculum reforms, teacher training, competence-based learning and access to education. Limited empirical research has investigated the predictive influence of education policy implementation on quality

education outcomes (Koboli et al., 2025). Therefore, this study seeks to examine how the implementation of the Education and Training Policy (2023) influences quality education, with particular attention to factors such as teacher's preparedness, institutional capacities and availability of teaching and learning materials integrated with technology because the extent to which policy implementation predicts improvements in these factors remains underexplored.

The Government of Tanzania introduced the Education and Training Policy of 2014(2023 edition) as part of its efforts to work for persistent challenges affecting the quality and relevance of education. Effective implementation of educational reforms requires careful planning, teacher development, and supportive school environments that align with national objectives and community needs. It requires Strong leadership, stakeholder collaboration and accountability inclusively. The reforms are expected to improve educational quality and align education system with national development goals through inclusive engagement in curriculum reforms implementation linking the knowledge, skills, and experience of all stakeholders.

Although previous studies have explored various aspects of education reforms in Tanzania, limited empirical research has examined the implementation of the Education and Training Policy (2023) as predictor of sustainable quality education on key implementation factors such as teacher's preparedness, institutional capacities and availability of teaching and learning materials integrated with technology. This gap creates uncertainty regarding whether the implementation of the 2023 education policy effectively contributes to improvements in educational quality. Therefore, this study seeks to examine the implementation of the Education and Training Policy (2023) and determine its predictive influence on quality education outcomes in Tanzania. The study will have three (3) objectives namely: (i) To assess the influence of teacher preparedness and professional development on quality education outcomes, (ii) To assess the effect of institutional capacity on quality education, and (iii) To assess the influence of inclusive teaching and learning materials integrated with technology in sustainable quality education in Tanzania.

LITERATURE REVIEW

Theoretical Literature Review

This study is guided by Policy Implementation and Systems Theories to explain how educational reforms

are implemented and how institutional systems influence educational outcomes. The Policy Implementation Theory explains how government policies are translated into practical actions and outcomes (Paudel, 2002; Pressman & Wildavsky, 1973). It highlights that policy success is influenced by the interaction between policymakers and implementers at different levels of the system (Pressman & Wildavsky, 1973). Policy implementation requires committed teachers, school leaders, administrators and all stakeholders to play a crucial role in translating policy intentions into classroom practices (O'Toole, 2014; Paudel, 2002).

Systems Theory, originally proposed by Ludwig von Bertalanffy, views organizations as systems composed of interconnected components that work together to achieve common goals (Bandura, 1991; Guberman, 1968; Laszlo & Krippner, 1998). Within an educational industry, schools function as open systems that receive inputs, transform them through teaching and learning processes, and produce outputs in the form of student learning outcomes (Laszlo & Krippner, 1998). The major components of the education system include teachers, resources and infrastructure as the inputs, curriculum implementation through proper teaching methods and a school timetable, routine and guidelines as the processes while skills acquisition and academic performance as the outputs where monitoring and evaluation are utilized as feedback mechanisms (Guberman, 1968; Panahandehpour et al., 2023)

Empirical Literature Review

Many scholars and experts agree that in order to cope with today's challenges it requires the upgrading of individuals' abilities to tackle complex mental tasks, working on accumulated knowledge and agree to learn new things daily. Key competencies involve a mobilization of cognitive and practical skills, creative abilities and other psychosocial resources such as attitudes, motivation and values required for individuals to learn, live and work with each other. (Anderson-Levitt & Gardinier, 2021)

The Education and Training Policy has brought about major reforms in the education sector with the aim of preparing citizens who are critical thinkers and a human resource that is educated, knowledgeable, skilled, and has a positive attitude towards contributing to the development of the nation (MoEST, 2023) hence a critical tension between access, expansion and education quality was identified. Implementation of the

policy focuses on a balance between education and the needs of the job market by fostering innovation and technology transfer with the purpose of building better future through effective school strategic leadership and administrative accountability mechanisms that create enabling environments to support both teachers and learners to enhance performance (Semindu & Kadigi, 2026).

Teacher preparedness and readiness is widely recognized as a key determinant of educational quality because teachers are the key implementors of the policy (Murphy, 2018). Studies have shown that teachers who receive adequate professional training are more effective in implementing curriculum reforms and improving student learning outcomes (Amponteng et al., 2026). Factors like age, gender, higher qualifications and professional experience influence technology integration. The integration of technology stands as a leading tool for transforming learning experiences (Mpuangnan, 2024).

Monitoring and evaluation mechanisms are essential for ensuring accountability and improving the effectiveness of education reforms (Ndale & Amos, 2025). Teaching evaluation assists in identification of challenges which hinder or interfere the provision of education. In the absence of strong monitoring systems, policy implementation efforts may become inconsistent and ineffective (Jeptepkeny & Keter, 2025; Meney, 2024). Effective professional development on inclusive education practices create a supportive school environment that improves teaching and learning outcomes for all students (Kasuga et al., 2025).

Institutional capacity refers to the ability of public institutions to implement the specific policy mandates for which they are responsible (Kim, 2026). An education institutional capacity can be described as the ability of a school as an institution to implement teaching and learning through effective leadership, infrastructure, and resource availability. The synchronization of educational competencies with labour market requirements enables Competence Based Curriculum be applied at schools which helps to create reduced youth joblessness and increased global business potential for Tanzania (Kasuga et al., 2025). Studies indicate that schools with strong leadership and adequate learning resources tend to achieve better academic performance (Shula & Heystek, 2025). Institutional quality has a positive effect on student achievement and school completion, and a negative effect on educational failure (Kim, 2026).

The Tanzania government formulated the Strategy for the Construction and Rehabilitation of Primary and Secondary School Infrastructure (2020-2024) which intended to provide guidance on the principles, procedures and standards required in the construction and rehabilitation of schools (MoEST, 2023). However, disparities in institutional capacity across schools particularly between urban and rural areas continue to affect the quality of education in many regions.

Effective curriculum implementation plays an important role in promoting competence-based learning and skill development (Munisi, 2025). Research shows that the successful implementation of competence-based curricula depends on teacher training, availability of instructional materials, and supportive learning environments (Kasuga et al., 2025). Due to the advancements in technology and communications, education in science and technology is a crucial tool in empowering citizens to understand their environment and contribute to the development of the nation (MoEST, 2023).

Teaching and learning materials integrated with digital technologies improve learning outcomes and access to quality teaching, learning and administration in educational institutions through the use of digital technologies hence enable every learner to be equipped with skills which significantly contribute towards national development (MoEST, 2025). However, curriculum reforms face challenges related to insufficient training, lack of teaching materials, and limited institutional support (Koboli et al., 2025). Challenges such as inadequate teaching and learning resources were highlighted, including shortages of classrooms and books (Meney, 2024; Mpuangnan, 2024; Shiboko, 2024).

Lacunae in the Reviewed Literature

Most of studies on Education and Training Policy 2014 (2023) Edition in Tanzania focused the review of its elements. Munisi (2025) made the study of The Elements of Competence-Based Education and Training in the Tanzania ETP 2014 (2023) Edition with the purpose is to enhance positive implementation of the policy and recommended that the policy could be used as a guide to scrutinize the policy content, as well as a lens to identify the focus of the content and related discourses such as Competence-Based Education and Training (Munisi, 2025). Losioki (2024) worked on challenges experienced in inclusive education among secondary schools and recommended that the Ministry

of Education Science and Technology, in collaboration with education stakeholders like Non-Government Organizations and community members, should ensure availability of supporting devices for special needs learners and ensure teachers are given in service special needs education training in order to improve teaching and learning outcomes in the inclusive environment.

Also, Meney (2024) studied on preparedness of public primary schools in Tanzania for implementation of educational reforms where findings indicated that teachers had moderate preparedness for implementation of educational reforms. Due to inadequacy of comprehensive training, teachers were engaged on self-directed learning and awareness of educational reforms. However, challenges such as inadequate teaching and learning resources were highlighted, including shortages of classrooms and books. The study recommended consistent provision of resources and comprehensive training programs to enhance readiness and ensure uniform implementation of reforms (Meney, 2024).

Although previous studies have explored issues related to teacher training, curriculum reforms, and education access, limited empirical research has examined the predictive influence of 2014 ETP (2023 edition) reforms implementation on quality education outcomes. This study examines the predictive influence on the Education and Training Policy of 2014(2023 edition) in Tanzania on attainment of quality education by assessing how teacher's preparedness, institutional capacities and availability of teaching and learning materials integrated with technology can enhance sustainability of quality education.

METHODOLOGY

This study utilized the systematic documentary review to examine policy documents, government reports, strategies, journal articles, international education studies, research reports, and scholarly publications related to education policy implementation and sustainable quality education selected based on their relevance to quality educational policy reforms implementation and institutional capacity. The review helped identify major themes and gaps in the literature. Documentary review is appropriate because this study aimed to analyze existing information from written sources and seeks to explore meanings, patterns, and interpretations within policy documentaries such as books, academic journals, policy documents, and

institutional reports (Schulforschung et al., 2023). The systematic approach ensures that the document selection process is transparent, rigorous, and replicable and reduce some of the ethical concerns associated with other qualitative methods (Morgan, 2022).

The review process adopted the Wellington's (2000) enquiry framework for generating information from documents. The framework involves asking detailed questions on the authorship, context, audience, product, intention, presentation, appearance and image as well as style, function and genre (Wellington, 2000). As for the purpose of this article only key questions based on authorship, context, audience, intention and presentation were asked. The answers obtained from these questions assisted in understanding the literal meaning and interpretive meaning of the Education and Training Policy of 2014 (2023) Edition.

A systematic search strategy was used to identify relevant documents for the study. Electronic academic databases and institutional repositories were searched using specific keywords related to the research topic. Keywords words such as Education policy implementation, Quality education, Teacher preparedness, Institutional capacity in education, Competence-based curriculum, Monitoring and evaluation in education and Education reforms in Tanzania were used. Relevant documents were obtained from academic databases such as Google Scholar, ERIC (Education Resources Information Center), Institutional repositories, Government and organizational websites.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

This article aimed at examining the Education and Training Policy of 2014(2023 edition) in Tanzania as predictive influence on the attainment of quality education by assessing on how teacher's preparedness, institutional capacities and availability of teaching and learning materials integrated with technology can enhance sustainability of quality education. This chapter presents and analyzes findings obtained through a qualitative systematic documentary review of policy documents, books, scholarly articles, and research reports related to the implementation of the ETP (2023) and its influence on quality education in Tanzania.

The findings are organized according to the major themes derived from thematic analysis, including teacher preparedness, institutional capacity, and availability of

teaching and learning materials integrated with technology.

Teacher Preparedness and Professional Development

The literature consistently highlights teacher preparedness as a crucial factor influencing the successful implementation of education and training policy of 2014 (2023 edition) and the achievement of quality education outcomes. The policy reviewed and all education aspects and laws in order to ensure the production of youth who are relevant and responsible to the society (MoEST, 2023). Various studies indicate that effective implementation of competence-based curricula requires teachers to possess adequate competences on pedagogical skills through professional training, and continuous professional development opportunities (Amponteng et al., 2026; Butoto, 2025; Mpuangnan, 2024; Munisi, 2025; Teachers et al., 2022).

Scholars argue that since the teachers are key and primary implementers of education policies within classrooms, their understanding of policy objectives, instructional strategies, and curriculum reforms is very significant in order to influence the effectiveness of educational reforms(Munisi, 2025; Shula & Heystek, 2025). However, several studies have reported challenges related to insufficient teacher training and limited professional development programs in many levels of education system in Tanzania hence prevent achievement of the sustainable quality education goal (Meney, 2024; Munisi, 2025; World bank, 2021).

The reviewed literature suggests that strengthening teacher professional development programs to the head of schools as the institutional instructional leaders and teachers as classroom instructional implementors can enhance teachers' ability to implement policy reforms effectively and improve students' learning outcomes (Munisi, 2025; Philip, 2022; Shula & Heystek, 2025). Heads of school should be well mentored and facilitated to perform their duties as required. Research findings suggest that strong monitoring systems contribute to improved school performance and better educational outcomes.

Institutional Capacity on Quality Education

Institutional capacity refers to the ability of educational institutions to provide the necessary environment and resources required for effective teaching and learning. The literature indicates that institutional capacity includes several components such as school leadership,

infrastructure, and administrative support systems (Nnunduma, 2022). Studies reviewed in this research emphasize that schools with strong institutional capacity tend to demonstrate better educational performance and improved student outcomes which will enable the achievement of Tanzania's Vision 2025 and 2050 (MoEST, 2026).

Financial capacity and effective leadership, in particular, on proper management of school infrastructure and resources through proper planning, plays a significant role in coordinating policy implementation and ensuring that educational reforms are successfully integrated into school practices (Talent & Sawe, 2022). However, several studies also highlight disparities in institutional capacity across schools, especially between urban and rural areas hence quality assurance is required to work on how to remove those differences of institutional capacity and other factors such as conducive and safe school environment (Mtitu, 2025).

Teaching and Learning Resources Integrated with Technology

Implementation of school timetable requires teaching and learning resources which are utilized to enhance proper understanding and enable the achievement of set objectives. Due to technological advancement, teaching and learning materials are required to be integrated with technology in order to meet the advancement and societal changes and world's agenda of inclusion (MoEST, 2025, 2026). The literatures identified the challenge of inadequate funding and insufficient laboratory equipment hence recommended that the government should ensure the consistent provision of essential educational resources in all its inclusive schools, including environmental education materials, reference books, special needs tools and digital tools through allocating sufficient budgetary (Talent & Sawe, 2022). Additionally, comprehensive training programs should be provided to teachers through regular professional development workshops and training sessions as to address the gaps in utilization of resources integrated with technology.

The findings from the reviewed literature indicate that the successful implementation of education policies depends on the interaction of several key factors which includes teacher preparedness, institutional capacity, and utilization of teaching and learning materials integrated with technology collectively influence the realization of quality education. The literature further suggests that weaknesses in any of these components may limit the

effectiveness of policy implementation and reduce the potentials expected on education reforms.

The findings of this study support theoretical perspectives emphasizing the importance of policy implementation processes in achieving educational goals. Effective implementation of education policies requires coordinated efforts among teachers, school leaders, society, policymakers and all school stakeholders. The reviewed literature confirms that teacher preparedness plays a central role in translating policy reforms into classroom practices. Similarly, institutional capacity provides the necessary resources and support systems required for effective policy implementation. The research finds that institutional stability still impedes significant changes in the curriculum hence suggests the application of more adaptable approach to curriculum management, enhanced involvement from stakeholders, and continuous support for staff training and technological resources. The findings also highlight the importance of curriculum reforms and its effective school monitoring and evaluation in day-to-day instructional activities of policy implementation using internal school quality assurance team as mechanisms of promoting continuous improvement of educational quality.

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the findings of the study, several conclusions can be drawn. First, the implementation of education policy plays a critical role in determining the quality of education outcomes. Education reforms alone are insufficient unless they are effectively implemented within educational institutions. Successful policy implementation requires coordinated efforts among teachers, school administrators, policymakers, and other education stakeholders. Second, teacher preparedness is a key determinant of effective policy implementation. Teachers must possess adequate pedagogical knowledge, professional training, and continuous professional development opportunities to implement 2023 ETP inclusively, effectively and successfully.

Third, institutional capacity significantly influences the effectiveness of education policy implementation. Schools with strong leadership and adequate infrastructure are better positioned to implement educational reforms and improve student learning outcomes proved through monitoring and evaluation systems which ensures that education policies are implemented effectively. Internal school quality assurance teams should be active and work effectively

to assist in school self-evaluation process for corrective measures. Fourth, presence of teaching and learning materials integrated with technology considering inclusions in schools is essential tool for education reform implementation for quality education outcomes in order to meet our education mission, vision and goals as well as new world order.

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